RURAL & LANDSCAPE PLANNING

Rural Development and Governance

- 6th lecture -

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Lecture outline

Key topics:

- Aims of rural development policy
- Means:
  >>Top-down Rural modernization
  >> Bottom-up Rural development

Key takeaways

Introduction

Aims of rural development (Michael Woods, 2010):

- Sustainable **economic growth**
- Improved **living standards** of rural population
- Bringing **rural areas up to national standards** of development
- Ensuring **rural regions are attractive** places to live
- Ensuring **rural places can contribute to the national economy**

>> **Means:** varied and contested

Introduction

Rural modernization paradigm

New rural development paradigm

Implications for rural governance

Modernization paradigm

- 1920s-1980s – key goal of modernization of rural places through state intervention
  >> TOP-DOWN GOVERNANCE

- Rural areas viewed as lagging, peripheral, backward, lacking economies of scale

- Modernization aspects included:
  >> Agricultural modernization
  >> Infrastructure investment (transport, electricity)
  >> Industrialization and attracting inward investment

>> EXOGENOUS DEVELOPMENT

Rural policy as agricultural policy

Post-war policy emphasis on **farming** support throughout the globe

Goals	Means
Food security	Agricultural industrialization and improvement
Maintain family farms	Specialization
	Subsidy and market intervention

Rural policy evolved into a **single sectoral support policy for agriculture**

Europe's Common Agricultural Policy

Established in 1962; the most dominant EU policy. Original aims:

- To support farmers and improve agricultural productivity
- Ensure stable supply of affordable food
- Safeguard European farmers to make a reasonable living

Tools:

- Subsidies; market control and interventions; direct payments (income support)

By 1985, CAP accounted for 78% of the entire European Commission budget

Europe's Common Agricultural Policy

Criticism of CAP:

- Farms become so productive that by mid-1980s, overproduction was a key concern
- Reinforcing regional disparities
- Benefitting larger farms
- Environmental impacts of intensive farming practices

CAP reforms ongoing from late 1980s

- Reducing link between production and subsidy

EU Policy

The Future of Rural Society (EU, 1988)

- Marked a shift from **sectoral/agricultural policy** to an integrated spatial approach to **rural territorial development**

- Introduction of **EU rural development policy: LEADER**

>> to support locally-led rural development projects and initiatives (agriculture, tourism, environmental conservation)

>> to empower rural communities to take more control over their own development

EU Policy

MacSharry reforms (1992)

- **shift from production-oriented subsidies to more market-oriented policies**

>> reducing subsidies for agricultural production

>> encouraging farmers to diversify their crops and production methods

>> promoting environmental and welfare standards

EU Policy

Pillars of EU rural policy

Extensification (less intensive farming)

- Landscape/environmental management
- Food safety
- Animal and welfare standards

Diversification of the rural economy

- Rural development programmes

Criticism of rural modernization paradigm

Lowe et al. (1998) critiques top-down, exogenous rural modernization agendas:

- **dependent development**, reliant on continued subsidies and the policy decision of distant agencies or boardrooms
- **distorted development**, which boosts single sectors, selected settlements and certain types of business, but leaves others behind and neglects non-economic aspects of rural life
- **destructive development**, as it erases the cultural and environmental differences of rural areas
- **dictated development**, as it is devised by external experts and planners

The new rural development paradigm

The 1990s have witnessed the emergence of a growing consensus in Europe concerning what rural development is and how it is best promoted.

"A broad notion, encompassing all important issues pertinent to the **individual and collective vitality of rural people and places**. It encompasses such as concerns as education, environment, individual and public health, housing, public services and facilities, capacity for leadership and governance, and cultural heritage as well as sectoral and general economic issues."

(OECD, 1990)

'Rural development can be defined as a sustained and sustainable process of economic, social, cultural and environmental change designed to enhance the **long-term well-being of the rural community**.'

(Moseley, 2003)

The new rural development paradigm

EU's rural development principles

Cork Declaration (1996)

it [rural development] must be decentralised as possible and based on partnership and cooperation between all levels concerned (local, regional, national and European). The emphasis must be on participation and a 'bottom-up', which harness the creativity and solidarity of rural communities. Rural development must be local and community-driven within a coherent European framework"

>> mix of the transnational and place-based approaches

The new rural development paradigm

Policy themes …

- Reappraisal of the rural resource base
- Integrated/multidimensional approaches
- Diversification of the rural economy
- ENDOGENOUS / 'Bottom-up' approach
- Place-based / territorial approach

Place-based rural development

For almost two decades rural policy has shifted from a sectoral support policy (agriculture) towards a territorial, spatial approach:

>> Embedding 'place' within rural development (OECD, 2006)

- Identity and culture
- Specificities
- Place attachment and community

Place-based rural development

shift from **modernisation** paradigm to **new rural development** paradigm

Table 20.1 Features of the modernisation paradigm and new rural development paradigm.

Modernisation paradigm	*New rural development paradigm*
Inward investment	Endogenous development
Top-down planning	Bottom-up innovation
Sectoral modernisation	Territorially based integrated development
Financial capital	Social capital
Exploitation and control of nature	Sustainable development
Transport infrastructure	Information infrastructure
Production	Consumption
Industrialisation	Small-scale niche industries
Social modernisation	Valorisation of tradition
Convergence	Local embeddedness

Source: Woods (2011)

Place-based rural development

	Old Paradigm	New Rural Paradigm (2006)
Objectives	Equalisation	Competiveness
Rural definition	Non-urban	Rural as a distinct variety of places
Key actors & stakeholders	Farm organisations and national governments	All levels of government and all relevant departments plus local stakeholders
Policy focus	Support for a single dominant resource sector	Support for multiple sectors based on their competitiveness
Tools	Subsidies for firms	Investments in qualified firms and communities
Policy approach	Uniformly applied top down policy	Bottom-up policy, local strategies

Source: OECD, 2019

Local rural development

- Europe's rural areas have increasingly embraced **local action** to face the challenge of the continued restructuring of agricultural sector
- **Shift away from reliance on central government policies** and large-scale enterprises and mobile capital
- **State withdrawing from service provision**
- **Communities** represent a more meaningful or human scale of organisation in world of trading blocks, giant corporations and big governments

>> Development from the bottom-up

DISCUSSION:

Based on what was previously elaborated during the lecture, reflect (individually or in small groups) on the following questions and provide clear argumentation for each answer. The answers may also be placed in Brightspace's Discussion section.

1. **What are the key features of the modernization paradigm?**

2. **What are the key features of the rural development paradigm?**

Case study: EU LEADER Programme

- EC programme for Integrated Rural Development
- LEADER: Links between Actions for the Development of the Rural Economy
- LEADER I – 1991-1994
- LEADER II – 1994-1999
- LEADER+ – 2000-2006

LEADER: key principles

The LEADER approach:

- Focus on a defined and **coherent area**
- Respect and build upon **local distinctiveness**
- Treat social, cultural, economic and environmental issues in an **integrated way**
- Develop a **partnership of relevant agencies** working to fulfil shared objectives
- Set individual projects and initiatives within the context of an agreed strategy
- Fully involve **local people** in both designing and delivering the programme

LEADER: key principles

An emphasis on the role of 'community'

- 'Rural development becomes unthinkable without the genuine involvement of local people' (Moseley, 1997)
- The essential idea is that community development involves development **by** and **of** the local community, not just **for** it
- Growing sense that decisions are more likely to stick if they are taken locally and represent a community consensus

Principles for effective local rural development

Promoting and disseminating both concepts and methods for rural development

- **Organising model**
  >> Partnerships, participation
- **Process of implementation**
  >> Animation, facilitation, and capacity building
- **Methodology**
  >> Strategic planning

LEADER: measures supported

- Technical support
- Vocational training
- Rural tourism
- Small-medium sized enterprises, craft enterprises and local services
- Exploitation of local agricultural, forest and fishing products
- Environment and living conditions
- Transnational projects

Critique of new rural development paradigm

Emphasis on community self-help

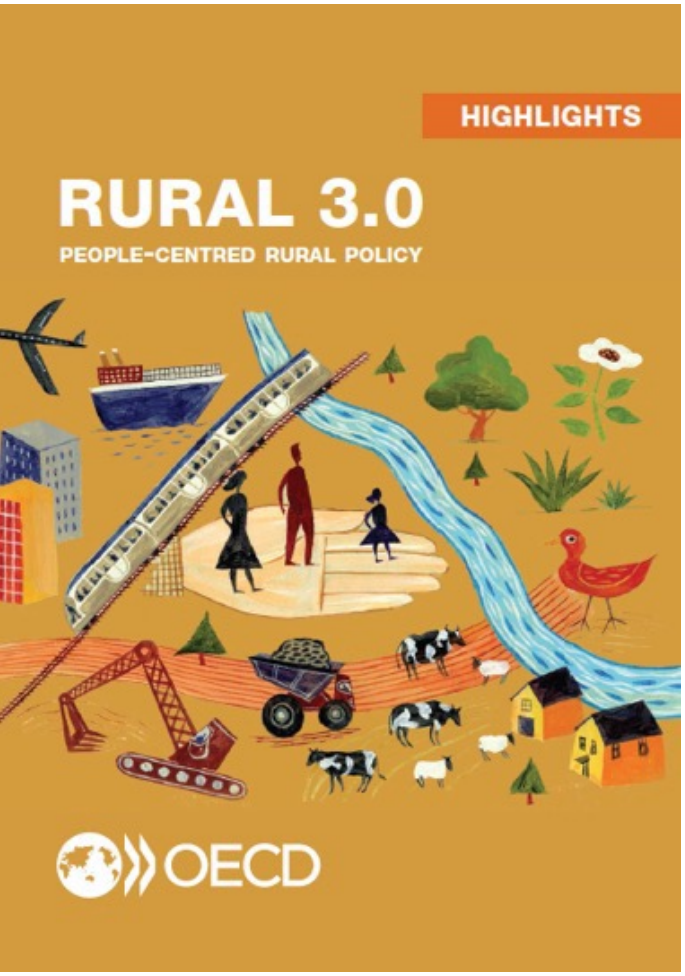
- Represents a **neoliberal restructuring of the state** and withdrawal of state services
- **Limited capacity** of some areas / communities / social groups to participate

Emphasis on the local: ignores outside influences

'The notion of local rural areas pursuing socio-economic development autonomously of outside influences (whether globalization, external trade or governmental or EU action) may be an ideal but is not a practical proposition in contemporary Europe.'

(Ward et al., 2005: 5)

OECD Rural 3.0 (2019)



OECD Rural 3.0

	Old Paradigm	New Rural Paradigm (2006)	Rural Policy 3.0 – A people centred approach to rural development
Objectives	Equalisation	Competiveness	Well-being considering three dimensions i) the economy, ii) society and iii) the environment
Rural definition	Non-urban	Rural as a distinct variety of places	Three types of rural i) within functional urban areas ii) close to functional urban areas iii) remote
Key actors & stakeholders	Farm organisations and national governments	All levels of government and all relevant departments plus local stakeholders	Involvement of: i) public sector – multi-level governance, ii) private sector – for-profit firms and social enterprise, and iii) third sector – non-governmental organisations and civil society
Policy focus	Support for a single dominant resource sector	Support for multiple sectors based on their competitiveness	Low-density economies differentiated by type of rural area
Tools	Subsidies for firms	Investments in qualified firms and communities	Integrated rural development approach – spectrum of support to public sector, firms and third sector
Policy approach	Uniformly applied top down policy	Bottom-up policy, local strategies	Integrated approach with multiple policy domains

Example:
Irish rural strategy «Our Rural Future 2021-2025»

Key goals

- Optimising digital connectivity
- Supporting employment
- Revitalising rural towns and villages
- Enhancing participation & leadership
- Enhancing public services
- Transitioning to carbon neutrality

DISCUSSION:

Based on what was previously elaborated during the lecture, reflect (individually or in small groups) on the following questions and provide clear argumentation for each answer. The answers may also be placed in Brightspace's Discussion section.

1. **What are the key features of the Rural 3.0 paradigm?**

Key takeaways

- Rural modernization: agendas, and its weaknesses
- Shift to a new rural development paradigm
- Case study of the LEADER programme
- New hybrid models of development